Topic 11 — Medieval Indian Cultural History (इतिहास)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Medieval Indian Art | Medieval Indian Architecture | Medieval Indian Literature | Medieval Indian Administration | Akbar (अकबर)'s Administration | Cultural Policies of Akbar

Sources: NCERT Themes II, An Introduction to Indian Art (Class 11), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs

- **Fatehpur Sikri** (फतेहपुर सीकरी), the **Taj Mahal** (ताज महल), and **Humayun (हुमायूँ)'s Tomb** remain UNESCO World Heritage (विश्व धरोहर) monuments. Tomb–city pairs and **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) still sit in the standing Mughal (मुग़ल) set.

11.1 Medieval Indian Art

Medieval art is Sultanate book-art, the Mughal kitabkhana, and Rajput and Pahari courts.

- Humayun, returning from Safavid exile, brings **Mir Sayyid Ali** and **Abdus Samad**. The Persian workshop enters India.
- **Akbar** (अकबर) runs the imperial **kitabkhana**. Indian colour and costume fuse with Persian composition.
- Akbar's illustrated sets include *Akbarnama* and ***Razmnama*** (Persian Mahabharata (महाभारत)).
- **Jahangir** marks the naturalism peak. **Ustad Mansur** is famed for birds and animals.
- Shah Jahan keeps court painting. Architecture takes the bigger purse.
- Under **Aurangzeb**, the imperial atelier shrinks. Painters move to Rajput and Deccan (दक्कन) courts.
- Rajput schools (Mewar (मेवाड़), Marwar (मारवाड़), Bundi, Kishangarh) use Hindu narrative and flat colour. They are not Mughal portrait naturalism.
- Pahari schools (Basohli (बसोहली), Guler, Kangra) paint hill Krishna-lila.
- **Pietra dura** (पिएत्रा ड्यूरा) (*parchin kari*) stone inlay represents the quintessential decorative art of Shah Jahan's monuments, most exquisitely displayed at the Taj Mahal.
- Calligraphy is a primary Islamic art, not a side craft.

Logic: Jahangir = Mansur / naturalism. Akbar = Razmnama atelier**. Rajput ≠ Mughal.

11.2 Medieval Indian Architecture

Medieval architecture brings the true arch (सच्चा मेहराब), the dome, and the charbagh. Learn monument, ruler, and city together.

- **Qutub Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) was started by **Aibak** and finished by **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश). It stands in Delhi.
- **Alai Darwaza** is by Alauddin Khalji. It is an early true-arch gateway.
- The Tughlaq look uses batter (slope), rubble and an austere style.
- **Sharqi Jaunpur (UP)** is known for **Atala Masjid**. It has a big screen-facade and weak minaret emphasis. It is not a Delhi clone.
- **Lal Darwaza Masjid** is at Jaunpur. It is the correct UP pair.
- **Adina Masjid** is at **Pandua / Bengal**, not Mandu (मांडू) — the classic unmatched pair in match lists.
- **Humayun's Tomb** stands in **Delhi**. It has a charbagh and a double dome. Haji Begum is associated with it.
- **Fatehpur Sikri** was Akbar's capital (about **1571–1585**). It was abandoned (water).
- **Buland Darwaza** is at Fatehpur Sikri. It commemorates the **Gujarat victory (1573)**. It does **not** mark Jahangir's birth (**1569**).
- **Panch Mahal** (पंच महल) is a five-storey open pavilion at Fatehpur Sikri. It is not the victory gate.
- The **Salim Chishti dargah** is white marble in the Fatehpur Jama Masjid (जामा मस्जिद) court.
- **Agra Fort** (आगरा किला) has Akbar's red-sandstone base. Shah Jahan's marble palaces stand inside.
- **Itimad-ud-Daulah** stands at Agra. It belongs to Nur Jahan (नूरजहाँ)'s father. It uses marble and pietra dura before the Taj.
- The **Taj Mahal** is at **Agra**. It was built by Shah Jahan for Mumtaz.
- The **Red Fort** (लाल किला) and **Jama Masjid** (जामा मस्जिद) are by Shah Jahan, in **Delhi**.
- **Bibi ka Maqbara** (बीबी का मकबरा) is Aurangzeb-era, at Aurangabad. It is called the "Poor man's Taj."
- **Babur**'s tomb city is **Kabul**.
- **Humayun**'s tomb city is **Delhi**.
- **Jahangir**'s tomb city is **Lahore**.
- **Shah Jahan**'s tomb city is **Agra**.

Vijayanagara (विजयनगर), Bahmani and Deccan cultural layer

Vijayanagara art is contemporary with the early Mughals. Hampi (हम्पी) holds the monuments. Deccan sultanate art sits beside it.

- **Vijayanagara** (capital tradition at **Hampi**) builds large Dravida (द्रविड़) temple complexes, bazaar streets, and royal platforms remembered in the UNESCO Hampi landscape.
- Musical-bhakti (भक्ति) colour includes **Purandaradasa** and related Carnatic (कर्नाटक) / Haridasa memory — do not park all medieval music under only Mughal courts.
- **Bahmani** and later Deccan sultanates (Bijapur (बीजापुर), Golconda (गोलकोंडा) / Qutb (कुतुब) Shahi, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, Berar) develop Deccani painting, tomb architecture, and Indo-Persian court culture beside the Mughal north.

- Deccani painting is a separate school from Mughal and Rajput — bold colour and Deccan court themes, not a Kangra clone.
- When a stem asks Mughal-era **south** culture, check Vijayanagara / Deccan first before forcing a Delhi–Agra answer.

> **Logic:** Buland Darwaza marks Akbar's **Gujarat** victory, not Jahangir's birth. Mughal tomb cities run Babur–Kabul, Humayun–Delhi, Jahangir–Lahore, Shah Jahan–Agra. Hampi = Vijayanagara, not a Mughal capital.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q49

Assertion (A): Mughal Emperor Akbar got the Buland Darwaza constructed at Fatehpur Sikri. Reason (R): Akbar got this monument constructed in memory of the birth of his son Jahangir.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Show answer

Ans: C. Gateway is real. Cause = **Gujarat victory**, not Jahangir’s birth.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q57

Match List-I with List-II.

List-I (Emperor) A. Babur B. Humayun C. Jahangir D. Shah Jahan

List-II (City of tomb) 1. Agra 2. Lahore 3. Delhi 4. Kabul

A. 4 3 2 1 B. 3 4 1 2 C. 3 4 2 1 D. 4 3 1 2

Show answer

Ans: A — 4 3 2 1.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q91

Arrange the following monuments in chronological order.

I. Rabia Daurani's Tomb, Aurangabad II. Shershah Suri's Tomb, Sasaram (सासाराम) III. Humayun's Tomb, Delhi IV. Atala Mosque, Jaunpur

A. I, II, IV, III B. IV, II, III, I C. II, I, III, IV D. III, IV, II, I

Show answer

Ans: B. Atala (~1408) → Sasaram (~1545) → Humayun (~1570) → Bibi ka Maqbara (~1660).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q19

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A. Adina Masjid – Mandu B. Lal Darwaza Masjid – Jaunpur C. Dakhil Darwaza – Gaur D. Tin Darwaza – Ahmedabad (अहमदाबाद)

Show answer

Ans: A. Adina Masjid = Pandua (Bengal), not Mandu.

11.3 Medieval Indian Literature

Medieval literature is Persian court prose, Turki memoir, Sanskrit–Persian translations, and Hindi bhakti books.

- **Babur** wrote *Tuzuk-i-Baburi / Baburnama* in **Chagatai Turki**. A later Persian translation was by Abdur Rahim (रहीम).
- The Mughal **court language was Persian**. Turki is not the official court tongue.
- **Abul Fazl** wrote *Akbarnama* (narrative) and *Ain-i-Akbari* (admin gazetteer). These are two books by one author.
- **Faizi** was the poet brother of Abul Fazl. He was poet laureate and died in **1595**.
- **Sheikh Mubarak** (their father) died in **1597**.
- **Abul Fazl** was murdered in **1602** (Vir Singh Bundela, on Salim's side).
- Prince **Daniyal** died in **1604**.
- **Gulbadan Begum** wrote *Humayunnama*. She was a daughter of **Babur**, not of Alauddin.
- **Hamida Banu Begum** was the wife of **Humayun** and mother of Akbar. She was **not** the wife of Alauddin Khalji.
- **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) belongs to the Sultanate and was a disciple of Nizamuddin. *Tughlaqnama* (तुग़लक़नामा) is **his**, not Ibn Battuta (इब्न बतूता)'s.
- *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* was written by **Minhaj-us-Siraj**.
- *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* is by **Barani** (बरनी) and also by **Shams-i-Siraj Afif** (same title, two works).
- **Nakhshabi** translated *Suka Saptati* as Persian ***Tutinama***. It is not by Khusrau.
- Firoz Tughlaq's Nagarkot / Jwalamukhi Sanskrit haul was rendered into Persian as *Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi* by **Azizuddin Khan**.
- Akbar's translation bureau rendered *Razmnama*, the Ramayana (रामायण) and the Atharvaveda (अथर्ववेद) into Persian.
- **Tulsidas** wrote *Ramcharitmanas* in Awadhi, in Akbar's century.
- **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati (सरस्वती)** of Banaras had **Shah Jahan** as patron.
- Numerous Sanskrit musical treatises were systematically translated into Persian during the Mughal era; while Sufi (सूफी) Chishti *sama* (समा) (musical audition) reflects spiritual devotion, it does not directly explain the court-sponsored imperial translation movement.

> **Logic:** Mughal memoirs were in **Turki**; court record ran in **Persian**. *Tughlaqnama* is not Ibn Battuta's work.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q3

Assertion (A): Babur wrote Tuzk-e-Babri in Chagatai Turki. Reason (R): Turki was the official language of the Mughal Court.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Show answer

Ans: C. Memoir = Turki. Court = **Persian**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q132

Arrange in chronological order:

1. Murder of Abul Fazl
2. Death of Sheikh Mubarak
3. Death of Faizi
4. Death of Daniyal

A. 2, 1, 4, 3 B. 3, 2, 1, 4 C. 2, 3, 1, 4 D. 2, 4, 3, 1

Show answer

Ans: B. Faizi 1595 → Mubarak 1597 → Abul Fazl 1602 → Daniyal 1604.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q34

Which of the following is **not** correctly matched?

A. Iltutmish — Father of Razia (रजिया) B. Shah Turkan — Wife of Iltutmish C. Hamida Banu Begum — Wife of Alauddin Khilji D. Gulbadan Begum — Daughter of Babur

Show answer

Ans: C. Hamida Banu = Humayun's wife.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q37

Who among the following translated the **300 volumes of Sanskrit books** collected by Firoz Shah Tughlaq during the campaign of Nagarkot?

A. Azizuddin Khan B. Talib Amuli C. Mulla Abdul Baqi D. Mirza Muhammad Ali

Show answer

Ans: A — Azizuddin Khan.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q43

Who among the following translated Chintamani Bhatt's Sanskrit text *Suka Saptati* into Persian and gave it the title *Tutinama*?

A. Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi B. Abdur Razzak C. Shihabuddin-al-Umari D. Amir Khusro

Show answer

Ans: A — Nakhshabi.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q146

Which Mughal ruler patronised Kavindra Acharya Saraswati of Banaras, a great scholar of Sanskrit and Hindi?

A. Shah Jahan B. Jahangir C. Akbar D. Humayun

Show answer

Ans: A — Shah Jahan.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q16

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj B. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siraj Afif C. Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta D. Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begam

Show answer

Ans: C. *Tughlaqnama* = **Amir Khusrau**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q90

Assertion (A): Many Sanskrit works on music were translated into Persian during the medieval period. Reason (R): The early Chishti sufis were fond of musical assemblies called 'sama'.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Show answer

Ans: B. Both true. Sama does not explain the court translation bureau.

11.4 Medieval Indian Administration

Sultanate administration uses the iqta and Khalsa frame. Its departments come before Akbar's mansab.

- Sultanate land is broadly **Khalsa** (crown, direct) and assigned holdings (**iqta** / later **jagir**).
- **Khalsa** was under **direct** state control. Revenue went to the treasury.
- An **iqta** was a revenue assignment to a **muqti / iqtadar**.
- The muqti **collects** and is expected to **maintain troops** from that revenue.
- Iqta revenue is **not** all deposited straight into the Sultan's account. That is the usual wrong option.

- *Siyasatnama* (Nizam-ul-Mulk (निजाम-उल-मुल्क)) is a source on iqta practice.
- Alauddin Khalji used market control, dagh (दाग़) (branding) and huliya (चेहरा) (descriptive roll) of cavalry.
- Sher Shah is known for roads, dak, the silver **rupiya** (रुपिया) and copper **dam** (दाम). Akbar keeps the dam idea.

Delhi Sultanate Central Administration & Departments Master Table

Department	Purpose / Function	Key Head / Creator	High-Yield Prelims Notes
Diwan-i-Wizarat (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत)	Finance, Taxation & Revenue	**Wazir** (Chief Minister / Prime Minister)	Central engine of administration; Khwaja Jahan under Tughlaqs.
Diwan-i-Arz (दीवान-ए-अर्ध / अरीज़)	Military Department, Troop inspection & rolls	**Ariz-i-Mumalik**; Created by **Balban**	Balban created it separate from Wazir to keep military under royal eye; Alauddin introduced *Dagh* (branding) & *Chehra/Huliya* (descriptive rolls).
Diwan-i-Insha (दीवान-ए-इंशा)	Royal correspondence, drafts, records & farmans	**Dabir-i-Khas**	State secrecy and official royal communication.
Diwan-i-Risalat (दीवान-ए-रसालत)	Foreign affairs, diplomatic envoys & religious appeals	Headed by Sadr / Chief Diplomat	Handled relations with other states and appeals.
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj (दीवान-ए-मुस्तखराज)	Arrears collection from revenue officials	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	To extract unpaid balances from Muqtis and Amils.
Diwan-i-Riyasat (दीवान-ए-रियासत)	Market control & economic regulation	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**; officer: *Shahna-i-Mandi*	Enforced strict price fixation in Delhi markets (Grain, Cloth/Sugar, Horses/Cattle).
Diwan-i-Kohi (दीवान-ए-कोही)	Agricultural development, uncultivated land & loans	Created by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (MBT)	Advanced agricultural loans (**Sondhar / Takkavi**) to peasants.
Diwan-i-Khairat (दीवान-ए-खैरात)	Charity, marriage grants for poor Muslim girls	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (FST)	Welfare department for widows and orphans.
Diwan-i-Bandagan (दीवान-ए-बंदगान)	Welfare & oversight of royal slaves (*ghulams*)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (had ~180,000 slaves)	Slaves trained in crafts, workshops, and army.
Dar-ul-Shafa (दार-उल-शफ़ा)	Free charitable hospitals	Established by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Free food and medicine distributed.

Sultanate Taxation System Matrix

Tax Name	Nature / Target	Standard Rate / Rule	High-Yield Exam Note
Kharaj (खराज)	Land revenue from non-Muslim agriculturalists	Usually 1/3rd to 1/2 of produce	Alauddin Khalji raised it to 50% (1/2) based on measurement (*Masaahat*).
Jizya (जज़िया)	Poll tax on non-Muslim subjects (*Zimmis*)	Graded by wealth (48, 24, 12 dirhams)	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq was the FIRST to impose Jizya on Brahmins** (earlier exempted). Abolished by Akbar in 1564; reimposed by Aurangzeb in 1679.
Zakat (ज़कात)	Religious charity tax on Muslims	2.5% on wealth/savings	Exclusively spent for poor Muslim relief.
Khams (खम्स)	State share of booty taken in war	Sharia: 1/5th to State, 4/5th to Soldiers	**Alauddin Khalji & MBT reversed it:** State took 4/5th, leaving only 1/5th to soldiers! Firoz Shah Tughlaq reverted back to orthodox 1/5th.
Haqq-i-Shurb (हक़-ए-शर्ब)	Water / irrigation canal tax	1/10th of agricultural produce	Imposed by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** on lands irrigated by royal canals.
Charai & Ghari (चराई एवं घरी)	House tax (*Ghari*) & Pasture tax (*Charai*)	Levied on cattle and houses	Introduced by **Alauddin Khalji**.

> **Logic: Jagirs** are assignable revenue rights, **not** direct crown land. Do not confuse **iqta** with jagir or zamindari.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q95

Assertion (A): The territories of the Sultanate could be broadly divided into two parts: the Khalsa and the Jagirs. Reason (R): The Jagirs comprised the land under the direct control of the State.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Show answer

Ans: C. Direct control = **Khalsa**, not jagir.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q15

Which one of the following is NOT the characteristics of Iqta System (इक्ता)?

A. Iqta was a revenue collection system B. Siyasatnama was the source of information for Iqta System C. Revenue from Iqta was directly deposited in Sultan's account D. Muqti was supposed to maintain troops out of the revenue collected from Iqta

Show answer

Ans: C. Muqti retains/uses the revenue for troops. It is not a full cash-in to the Sultan.

11.5 Akbar's Administration

Akbar's administration is built on the **mansab**, **zabt**, and **suba** (सूबा) framework. Todar Mal shaped the revenue system. Sher Shah's currency continuity was preserved and codified.

Master Matrix: Mughal Provincial Administration Evolution (Subas)

Reign / Timeline	Total Subas (Provinces)	List of Subas / Additions
Akbar (1580 — *Ain-i-Akbari*)	**12 Subas** (original division)	Agra, Delhi, Allahabad, Awadh, Ajmer, Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Bihar, Bengal, Malwa, Lahore, Multan, Kabul.
Late Akbar (Post-Deccan Annexations)	**15 Subas** (mature map)	+3 Deccan subas added: **Berar** (बरार), **Khandesh** (खानदेश / renamed Dandesh), and **Ahmadnagar** (अहमदनगर).
Jahangir	**15 – 17 Subas**	Retained 15; added **Orissa** (separated from Bengal) and Kangra.
Shah Jahan	**18 – 22 Subas**	Expanded to 18–22; split Deccan into 4 subas (Khandesh, Berar, Daulatabad, Telangana); added **Kashmir** (separated from Kabul) and **Thatta / Sindh**.
Aurangzeb (Maximum Extent)	**21 Subas** (Peak of Mughal Empire)	14 in North India, 1 in Afghanistan (Kabul), and 6 in Deccan (+**Bijapur** in 1686, +**Golconda** in 1687). Total = **21 Subas**.

Mughal Currency Matrix (Coins, Metals, & Ratios)

Metal	Coin Name	Weight / Standard	Ratio / Important Facts
Silver (चांदी)	**Rupiya** (रुपिया)	**178 grains** pure silver (standardized by **Sher Shah Suri**)	Akbar continued Sher Shah's silver Rupiya. Remained the monetary standard throughout Mughal era.
Copper (तांबा)	**Dam** (दाम / पैसा)	**380 grains** pure copper (introduced by **Sher Shah Suri**)	**Exchange Ratio:** • Under **Sher Shah: 1 Rupee = 64 Dams**. • Under **Akbar: 1 Rupee = 40 Dams** (most frequent exam question!). Fractions: *Adhela* (1/2 dam), *Paulah* (1/4 dam), *Damri* (1/8 dam).
Gold (सोना)	**Mohur / Ashrafi** (मोहर / अशरफ़ी)	Approx 169–170 grains	Standard gold coin; equivalent to **9 to 10 silver rupees**. Akbar's square gold coin was called **Jalali**; round coin was **Ilahi**. Largest gold coin: **Sahansah** (शहंशाह — 101 tolas, used for ceremonial gifts).

Land Classification under Dahsala System (Ain-i-Dahsala — Todar Mal, 1580)

Land Class	Cultivation Frequency	Tax Assessment Rule
Polaj (पोलज)	Cultivated continuously every year; never allowed to lie fallow.	Paid full revenue every year; highest yield class.
Parauti (परौती)	Left fallow temporarily for 1 or 2 years to recover fertility.	Paid full revenue only when under cultivation.
Chachar (चाचर)	Left uncultivated/fallow for 3 or 4 years.	Assessed at progressively concessional rates when brought back to plough.
Banjar (बंजर)	Uncultivated for 5 or more years; poorest wasteland.	Minimal token tax to incentivize reclamation.

Measurement Reforms: Replaced Sikandari Gaz with **Gaz-i-Ilahi** (39 digits / 41 anguls; ~33 inches). Replaced hemp rope with **Tanab** (bamboo sticks joined by iron rings) to prevent stretching/shrinking in different seasons.

Mansabdari System Evolution & Traps

- **Dual Rank: Zat** (व्यक्तिगत पद — determined personal status and salary) and **Sawar** (सवार — number of cavalrymen and horses to be maintained).
- **Three Classes of Mansabdars:** 1. 1st Class: Zat = Sawar 2. 2nd Class: Zat > Sawar (but Sawar \ge 1/2 Zat) 3. 3rd Class: Sawar < 1/2 Zat *(Note: Sawar could NEVER exceed Zat rank!)*
- **Du-Aspa Sih-Aspa (दो-अस्पा सिंह-अस्पा):** Introduced by Emperor **Jahangir**. Allowed selected mansabdars to maintain double or triple number of horses without increasing their *Zat* status.
- **Month-Scale System (माहाना प्रणाली):** Introduced by **Shah Jahan**. When actual realization (*Hasil*) fell far short of estimated revenue (*Jama*), jagirs were allotted on a 4-month, 6-month, or 8-month basis.
- **Highest Hindu Mansabdar Ratio:** Paradoxically under **Aurangzeb** (approx **31.6% to 33%** of mansabdars above rank 1000 were Hindus, mostly Maratha chieftains recruited during Deccan campaigns, higher than Akbar's ~22%).
- **Non-Hereditary Nature:** Mansabdari was strictly **not hereditary**. On death of a mansabdar, all his property was seized by the state under the law of **Escheat** (*Zabti*).

Local Administrative Hierarchy (Empire to Village)

Level	Administrative Unit	Chief Executive / Military Officer	Chief Revenue / Financial Officer	Other Key Functionaries
Central	Empire (साम्राज्य)	Emperor	**Wazir / Diwan** (finance)	**Mir Bakshi** (military & mansab), **Mir Saman** (stores & karkhanas), **Sadr-us-Sudur** (ecclesiastical & judicial head)
Provincial	**Suba** (सूबा — Province)	**Subahdar / Sipahsalar**	**Provincial Diwan** (directly appointed by Centre)	**Bakshi** (provincial army), **Sadr/Qazi** (judiciary), **Kotwal** (city law & order)

Level	Administrative Unit	Chief Executive / Military Officer	Chief Revenue / Financial Officer	Other Key Functionaries
District	**Sarkar** (सरकार — District)	**Faujdar** (military commander & police)	**Amalguzar** (revenue assessment & collection)	**Kotwal** (head of city administration), **Bitikchi** (accountant/writer), **Khazandar** (treasurer)
Sub-District	**Pargana** (परगना — Tehsil)	**Shiqdar** (law, order, executive head)	**Amil / Munsif** (revenue assessment & collection)	**Fotadar** (treasurer), **Qanungo** (hereditary keeper of land & revenue records)
Village	**Gram / Mauza** (ग्राम — Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal** (village headman)	**Patwari** (village accountant)	Village Panchayat / Council

- **Bairam Khan** (बैरम खान) was vakil / regent in Akbar's early years. The title **Khan-i-Khanan** came from **Humayun**, not as a fresh Akbar gift at vazir-appointment.

> **Logic:** Mansab ≠ **hereditary. Dam** is Sher Shah's copper that Akbar keeps.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q4

Consider the following statements with reference to Bairam Khan:

1. Akbar gave the title of Khan-i-Khana to Bairam Khan.
2. This title was not given at the time of appointment of Bairam Khan as Vazir (वक़ील) of Empire.

A. Both 1 and 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Only 1 D. Only 2

Show answer

Ans: D — Only 2.Humayun conferred Khan-i-Khanan. Akbar did not bestow it as a vazir-joining gift.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q12

Assertion (A): Akbar, like Sher Shah, tried to regulate the currency of the state. Reason (R): As in Sher Shah's currency, the chief copper coin of Akbar's time was the Dam.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Show answer

Ans: A. Dam is the copper fact that shows the Sher Shah continuity.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q92

With reference to Mansabdari system, which of the statements is/are correct?

1. Mansabdari system was the official nobility of the state, started by Akbar.
2. A Mansabdari was hereditary.

A. 1 only B. Both 1 and 2 C. 2 only D. Neither 1 nor 2

Show answer

Ans: A — 1 only. Rank is not hereditary in Akbar's design.

11.6 Cultural Policies of Akbar

Sulh-i-kul is Akbar's public line of peace with all. **Din-i-Ilahi** is a small private order.

- The **Ibadat Khana** was set up in **1575** at Fatehpur Sikri. It began with ulema (उलेमा) debates and was later opened to other faiths.
- The **Mahzar** belongs to **1579**. It is the so-called infallibility decree. Akbar became final arbiter in religious dispute among ulema.
- **Sulh-i-kul** means peace with all. It was a public governance ethic, not a church.
- **Din-i-Ilahi / Tauhid-i-Ilahi** began in **1582** as a small discipleship around Akbar. **Birbal** is the famous Hindu join. It was **not** a state religion and was **not** forced on the empire.
- **Jizya** was abolished in **1564**. Aurangzeb later brings it back. That is a different reign.
- Hindu nobles at court included **Man Singh** (मान सिंह), **Todar Mal** and **Birbal**.
- The Navaratna culture names to raata are **Tansen**, **Todar Mal**, **Birbal**, **Abul Fazl** and **Faizi**.
- **Tansen** was earlier at the court of **Raja Ramchandra of Bhata / Rewa**. He then joined Akbar.
- The translation house rendered Sanskrit epics and Vedas into Persian (*Razmnama*).
- Marriage alliances with Rajputs are policy, not a painting school.

> **Logic:** Din-i-Ilahi ≠ state religion. Ibadat Khana ≠ Fatwa-i-Alamgiri** (that is Aurangzeb).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q89

Who among the following kings had given patronage to Tansen before Akbar?

A. Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata B. Rajbahadur of Malwa C. Uday Singh of Mewar D. Muzaffar Shah of Gujarat

Show answer

Ans: A — Ramchandra of Bhata.
